

PRODUCTION BRIEF · V1.1

THRESANTM

Skyflag · Rulebook v21

*Instructions for producing the final distributable rulebook from v19.1.
Incorporates every brand, naming, and design-of-rules lesson learned
during the construction of the web prototype and the surrounding
brand surfaces.*

Three worlds. One proof.

Limnology Research Corp. · Brief v1.1 · 2026-05-14

0 • Purpose

This document is the build brief, not the rulebook. Read it once, then use it as a working checklist while editing the source text into a print- and web-ready edition.

Estimated effort: one editor working focused, 5–10 days from source-text edit to print-ready PDF, plus 2–3 days for cover and illustrations if those are produced fresh rather than licensed from existing brand assets.

1 • Source materials

- **v19.1 source** — `docs/rulebook-v19.1.pdf` . Canonical text reference. Most rule content carries forward unchanged.
- **v20 interim** — `scripts/rulebook-v20.html` . Most recent text pass; already incorporates the 4-pieces-per-side clarification, the Cross-Board Rule, and the trademark-pivot sweep (Kaleo Edition references removed as of 2026-05-13). *Start from this.*
- **Brand reference** — the canonical brand-system image (sigil, palette, wordmark, clans, piece templates). The master copy lives at `{' } /Users/nelson/Documents/SkyFlag/LOGO - Tresan/Thresan Font, colour palette, typography.png` .
- **Brand surfaces (for tone/voice consistency)** — `thresan.com` , `thresan.studio` , `thresan.games` , `thresan.io` , `thresan.store` . Each anchors a register; the rulebook should read as a sibling to these, not a third-party document.

2 • Brand and naming changes

This is the load-bearing section. Apply throughout the rulebook; nothing else in the brief matters if this sweep is incomplete.

2.1 The framing pivot

Old framing: "Thresan is the universe; Skyflag is the game within it; Kaleo Edition is the first setting."

New framing: *Thresan*[™] is the game (rules-level identity, like chess). *Skyflag* is its current

edition — the pieces, the boards, and the storyboard set in the world of *Kaleo*. Future editions of Thresan keep the rules and change the storyboard.

Locked 2026-05-13 across every public-facing surface. Reflect the same framing throughout the rulebook.

2.2 Title-form usage

- **Long form:** *Thresan: Skyflag*.
- **Short form:** *Thresan* (when context is clear), or *Skyflag* (when specifically the edition).
- **Trademark:** ™ goes on *Thresan* only. Never on *Skyflag* alone. Apply ™ to the first prominent occurrence per major section (cover, front-matter, foreword), not to every instance.

2.3 Sweep targets

Drop every instance of "Kaleo Edition" as a subtitle. Three places it commonly appears:

- Title page lockup → replace with *Thresan: Skyflag — Rulebook v21*.
- Running footer → replace with *Thresan: Skyflag · Rulebook v21 · §N*.
- "About this edition" / colophon page → rewrite per §2.4.

In running prose, replace any "first game in the Thresan universe" phrasing with "current edition of Thresan."

2.4 New colophon paragraph (front matter)

Recommended draft text — edit as needed:

"Thresan is a strategy game. Skyflag is its current edition — the pieces, the boards, and the storyboard set in the world of Kaleo. The rules in this book describe Thresan; the names, art, and narrative describe Skyflag. Future editions of Thresan may rename the pieces, redress the boards, and rewrite the world. The rules will not change."

3 · Lessons learned during the build

Surfaced during construction of the web prototype, brand surfaces, and physical-edition concept work. Most are already folded into v20; verify before final layout.

3.1 Piece count (the v19.1 ambiguity that burned testers)

v19.1 was ambiguous about piece counts. Make it explicit on the setup page:

- **5 pieces per player** (10 total): one Captain, one Soldier, one Promoted Soldier Captain (swap-in on promotion), one Rover, one Pilot.
- Each piece is distinct in role, movement, and starting position. Pieces are not interchangeable tokens. The Promoted Soldier Captain enters play only when a Soldier reaches the far rank — until then it sits beside the board.

3.2 Cross-Board Rule edge cases

Several edge cases emerged during app development that should be codified into the rulebook proper rather than living in errata:

- **Lift-during-capture sequencing** — define which resolves first.
- **Simultaneous claim-seal threat resolution** — when one move threatens multiple seals in a single turn.
- **Nexus capture preconditions** — required state of the Captain piece for the Nexus-win path to be legal.

3.3 Win condition language

Clarify both win paths with sentence-level precision. Recommended phrasing:

1. **Path of seals:** capture all three of the opposing clan's claim-seals — one on each plane (Terran, Meridian, Empyrean).
2. **Path of the Nexus:** land your Captain on the Caelum Nexus at Space(3,3).

Specify what happens if both conditions are achieved on the same turn (default: seals resolve first; document it).

3.4 Terminology consistency

Choose one term per concept and stick to it across the rulebook:

- "*claim-seal*" in lore prose; "*flag*" in mechanical rules sections. Acceptable to use both if labeled clearly; pick one if a single voice is preferred.
- "*Lift*" with capital L when naming a Lift mechanism; lowercase when used as a verb.
- "*Nexus*" always capitalized when referring to the Caelum Nexus square.

3.5 Time control note

If supporting tournament play (or even friendly online multiplayer with optional clocks), add a one-page appendix on time controls: per-move budget, per-game budget, increment. Currently absent from v19.1.

3.6 Promotion lore sidebar

Add the medical-event flavor framing for Soldier-to-Captain promotion (Durren → Dantec transformation) as a lore sidebar. Surfaced during app development as a memorable narrative beat that strengthens the constructive-proof framing.

4 · Look and feel

4.1 Palette (canonical hex codes — use these exactly)

	Aether Gold #C2A46B	Primary accent: section headings, sigil overlays, decorative rules.
	Aether Copper #8B6A48	Lift mechanisms in diagrams. "Machinery, lifts, forged metal."
	Terran Sand #CBB79A	Terran-plane illustrative elements.
	Meridian Teal #4A6D6F	Meridian-plane diagrams.
	Empyrean Indigo #111826	Primary text on light bg; primary background on covers/section breaks.
	Stag Bone #E6E2D8	Body text on dark backgrounds; White Stags / P2 surfaces.
	Raven Slate #2B3138	Grey Ravens / P1 surfaces.

4.2 Typography

- **Wordmark:** refined geometric type, wide tracking (0.22em on THRESAN, 0.04em on SKYFLAG subhead). Currently raster only; commissioning a proper font file is flagged in §8.
- **Body:** Crimson Pro (serif) or Inter (sans). Pick one for the print rulebook. Inter recommended for clarity in mechanical rules; Crimson Pro for lore sidebars and the story foreword.
- **Section headings:** Inter Bold, Aether Gold, with a 2pt rule underline in Aether Gold.
- **Monospace** (for coordinate notation like `Space(3,3)`): JetBrains Mono or Menlo.

4.3 Sigil placement

- **Cover** — large sigil centered above wordmark lockup.
- **Section breaks** — small sigil decorative element, centered.
- **Running footer** — minimal: sigil glyph + page number.

4.4 Page layout

- **Trim size:** Letter (8.5×11) for first print. Switch to A5 if going to a games-specific publisher later.
- **Margins:** 0.85in all around, 1.0in bottom for footer.
- **Binding:** saddle-stitch for ≤40 pages; perfect bind for ≥48.
- **Cover material:** matte black with gold foil for the sigil — fits the "monastery, not tech" aesthetic. Sample on press before full run.

4.5 Diagrams

- Every diagram uses the brand palette.
- Each diagram annotated with the relevant rule section number (e.g., see §4.2).
- Board representations: choose isometric or top-down — pick one and use it throughout. Recommended: top-down for mechanical rules (cleaner), isometric for chapter openers (more evocative).

5 · Concept framing

5.1 Tagline placement

"*Three worlds. One proof.*" appears in three places:

- Cover (lower third, scripted/handwritten font for warmth).
- Last page (centered, restrained).
- Each section divider as a small footer mark.

5.2 Constructive-proof framing

In the introduction, frame the game as a *constructive proof* — distinct from chess's contradiction proof. Both Thresan win conditions are positive demonstrations of reach across the three planes, not eliminations of the opponent. This is the conceptual hook that distinguishes Thresan from its eight-by-eight ancestor. Cross-reference{' '} thresan.io / "*The proof of three*" for full framing — but condense to one paragraph for the rulebook intro.

5.3 Tone

- Authoritative but warm. This is a rulebook, but written by one person, for two people sitting across a table.
- Avoid corporate plural ("we") in rule text. First-person OK in foreword and acknowledgments.
- Lore sidebars set in italic Crimson Pro, visually distinct from rule text. Never blur the line between rule and lore — readers need to know which is binding.

6 · Distribution

6.1 File deliverables

- **Print-ready PDF** — CMYK, 300 DPI, embedded fonts, 0.125in bleed, crop marks.
- **Web PDF** — RGB, 150 DPI, hyperlinked TOC, smaller file size for fast download.
- **EPUB** — optional for v2; v1 can skip if scope is tight.

6.2 Hosting

- Print-ready: not on website; sent to printer directly.
- Web PDF: linked from `playskyflag.com/help` ("Download the rulebook").
- Press kit: include web PDF in the assets grid at `playskyflag.com/press`.

6.3 Version control

- Repository copy: `docs/rulebook-v21.pdf`.
- Source HTML: keep `scripts/rulebook-v21.html` updated in lockstep.
- Markdown source: consider extracting if this becomes a living document with regular edits.

7 • Production checklist

In order — don't skip ahead, especially on §2.

- ☐ Pull `scripts/rulebook-v20.html` as starting copy.
- ☐ Brand sweep — confirm zero "Kaleo Edition" instances remain (already done in v20 as of 2026-05-13; re-verify).
- ☐ Apply framing pivot — write the new colophon paragraph (§2.4); edit the intro to lead with the Thresan-as-game framing.
- ☐ Verify all lessons-learned edits (§3.1–§3.6) are reflected in the text.
- ☐ Add Cross-Board Rule edge cases (§3.2) as numbered subsections of the relevant rule.
- ☐ Add appendix: time controls (§3.5).
- ☐ Add lore sidebar: Soldier-to-Captain promotion (§3.6).
- ☐ Visual pass — verify palette, typography, sigil placement per §4.
- ☐ Diagram audit — every diagram uses brand palette; rule cross-references present.
- ☐ Cover design — gold-foil sigil mockup; review on press sample before full run.
- ☐ External proof reader — one fresh pair of eyes (the brothers, who've been playtesters, are

the natural pick).

- ☐ Generate print-ready PDF (CMYK, 300 DPI, embedded fonts, bleed, crop marks).
- ☐ Generate web PDF (RGB, 150 DPI, hyperlinked TOC).
- ☐ Upload web PDF to `playskyflag.com/help` and press kit.
- ☐ Send print-ready to print shop with sample request.

8 · Open decisions (flag for Nelson)

- **Final version number** — v21 (continues sequence) or v1.0 (resets to "first distributable edition" numbering)?
- **Print run size** — depends on Kickstarter pledge targets; gating input.
- **Trim size** — Letter (US default) vs A5 (games-publisher convention)?
- **Cover material** — matte black + gold foil for all tiers, or upgrade material at premium tiers (cloth bind, leather, etc.)?
- **Translations** — English-only for v1; flag a v2 for German/French/Japanese if Kickstarter signal supports it.
- **Custom font commission** — the THRESAN wordmark currently lives only as raster art. Commissioning a proper font file would future-proof every brand surface (rulebook, packaging, future editions). Estimate \$2k–6k via a designer.
- **Illustration licensing** — if external illustrators are hired, contract for commercial print + digital + derivative-edition use up front.

9 · What this brief deliberately does *not* include

- **Specific rule text edits** — these live in the source documents and are referenced by section number.
- **Pricing / distribution business decisions** — separate plan; covered in `project_thresan_store` notes.

- **Back-cover marketing copy** — drafted separately by Nelson.
- **Legal text** (ISBN, copyright notice, country-of-print) — handled at the printer's intake step.

10 • Revision history

v1.0 · 2026- 05-13	Initial publication. Drafted after the May 2026 brand framing pivot (Thresan = game; Skyflag = current edition; "Kaleo Edition" subtitle retired). Locks the §2 brand sweep, §3 lessons-learned from the app build, and the ordered §7 production checklist.
v1.1 · 2026- 05-14	Piece-count narrative unified across all surfaces. The roster is five pieces per side (10 total): Captain, Soldier, Promoted Soldier Captain, Rover, Pilot. The Promoted Soldier Captain is a swap-in piece that enters play when a Soldier reaches the far rank — it sits beside the board until promotion happens. Previous brief copy said "4 pieces per player (8 total)" which omitted the swap-in piece and contradicted the locked parts list.

Bump the minor number (v1.1, v1.2, ...) for clarifications or added items. Bump the major number (v2.0) for structural changes that invalidate work done against an earlier brief. Snapshot each released cut to `Documents/SkyFlag/rulebook-distribution-brief-v<n>.{html,pdf}` .

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